AI EXPLAINED SIMPLY

Prompt templates that make AI answers specific

Why it works. Anthropic's prompt-engineering guide says to think of the model as a brilliant but new employee who lacks context on your norms and workflows: the more precisely you explain what you want, the better the result. (Source: Anthropic docs, "Be clear and direct".)

The 5-part template

> **Role:** You are a [role].

> **Audience:** The reader is [who they are].

> **Task:** Write/Explain/Summarize [what exactly].

> **Format:** [length, structure, e.g. three lines, bullet list].

> **Tone:** [friendly, formal, direct].

Example: vague vs specific

- Vague: *Write me a marketing email.* → bland, generic output.
- Specific: *You are a copywriter. The reader owns a dental clinic. Write a three-line email with a friendly tone, one clear offer, and end with a question.* → focused and ready to edit and send.

Copy-paste templates

1. **Email:** You are a [role]. Write a [N]-line email to [audience]. Tone: [tone]. One clear offer: [offer]. End with a question.

2. **Summary:** You are an analyst. Summarize the text below for [audience] in [N] bullet points, each under 15 words. Then list one open question.
3. **Explain:** Explain [topic] to [audience] using one everyday analogy and one example. Keep it under [N] words.

Tips

- Add context the model cannot guess: who it is for, what you already tried, what "good" looks like.
- Say the format you want (length, bullets, table).
- If the answer is off, change one part of the template and compare.

Sources: Anthropic, Prompt engineering overview, "Be clear and direct" (docs.anthropic.com).

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